

039. Chapter 3 Verses 35-37

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.35

श्रेयान्स्वधर्मो विगुणः परधर्मात्स्वनुष्ठितात् ।
स्वधर्मे निधनं श्रेयः परधर्मो भयावहः ॥ 35 ॥

śreyānsvadharmaḥ viguṇaḥ
paradharmātsvanuṣṭhitāt |
svadharmaḥ nidhanaṁ śreyaḥ
paradharmo bhayāvahaḥ ||

◆ śreyān – better; sva-dharmaḥ – one's own duty; viguṇaḥ – though devoid of merit; ◆ paradharmāt – than the duty of another; su-anuṣṭhitāt – well-performed; ◆ svadharmaḥ – in one's own duty; nidhanam – death; śreyaḥ – better; ◆ para-dharmaḥ – another's duty; bhaya-āvahaḥ – fraught with fear.

One's own duty, ill-performed and without merit, is better than the duty of another well-discharged. Better is death in discharging one's own duty. Another's duty is fraught with fear.

VERSE 3.36

अर्जुन उवाच ।

अथ केन प्रयुक्तोऽयं पापं चरति पूरुषः ।

अनिच्छन्नपि वार्ष्णेय बलादिव नियोजितः ॥ 36 ॥

arjuna uvāca |

atha kena prayukto'yaṁ

pāpaṁ carati pūruṣaḥ |

anicchannapi vārṣṇeya

balādiva niyojitaḥ ||

◆ arjunaḥ uvāca – Arjuna said; ◆ atha – then; kena – by what; prayuktaḥ – impelled; ayam – this; ◆ pāpaṁ – sin; carati – commits; pūruṣaḥ – man; ◆ anicchan – not wishing; api – even; vārṣṇeya – O Varshneya (Krishna); ◆ balāt – by force; iva – as if; niyojitaḥ – constrained.

Arjuna said: O Krishna! Constrained by force as it were, by what does man commit sin even against his wish?

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

काम एष क्रोध एष रजोगुणसमुद्भवः ॥

महाशनो महापाप्मा विद्ध्येनमिह वैरिणम् ॥ 37 ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |

kāma eṣa krodha eṣa

rajoguṇasamudbhavaḥ |

mahāśano mahāpāpmā

viddhyenamiha vairiṇam ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said; ◆ kāmaḥ – desire; eṣaḥ – this; krodhaḥ – anger; eṣaḥ – this; ◆ rajo-guṇa – the mode of passion; samudbhavaḥ – born of; ◆ mahā-aśanaḥ – all-devouring; mahā-pāpmā – all-sinful; ◆ viddhi – know; enam – this; iha – here; vairiṇam – the enemy.

**The Blessed Lord said: It is desire, it is anger, born of
Rajoguna (the impulse of action), all-consuming and all-evil.
Know this as the enemy here.**